

Editorial

Dear Readers,

Ubuntu's latest release is out and it has got us all excited. Naturally, the *LFY Labs* made sure that the *Maverick Meerkat* (codename for Ubuntu 10.10) got pride of place on this month's *LFY DVD*. And from the feedback we've received on Facebook and Twitter, our decision has obviously thrilled our readers.

So now you know that whenever you want us to bundle your favourite distro along with *LFY*, the best way to influence us is to make other members of the community support your recommendation through Facebook and Twitter!

Coming back to Ubuntu 10.10, there's more in store for you. Apart from a detailed review of the distro, we've also carried '6 interesting tweaks' for Ubuntu on Page 20, and an interesting review of the latest edition of Ubuntu Studio (10.10) for readers who are into multimedia (Page 28). The Studio is a nice compilation of the leading open source multimedia tools—so if you are into audio, video, graphics or animation, here's your one-stop solution.

What I really like about this issue are the many hands-on articles. If you want to discover the easy way to developing applications for the Android platform using Google App Inventor, there's a nice piece on Page 44. For the IT admin folks, the management of data centres has been simplified on Page 92. And, even after trying Ubuntu Studio, if you are still looking at more options for video editing, check out the piece on the Pitivi Video Editor (Page 42). The cherry on the cake is the article on accessing your laptop through an Android device.

While Linux has always faced serious challenges in gaining popularity on laptops and desktops, it's been a different story altogether with netbooks. We have seen different flavours of Linux being bundled along with many netbooks, and not just as a price-cutting measure, but as a complete bundled product. On Page 38, you'll find an interesting comparison of leading open source

desktop environments for your netbook—KDE, MeeGo and Ubuntu.

Lastly, it's the 'tablet' that's catching everyone's fancy these days. Apple has managed to occupy the No 1 position in yet another gadget category with the iPad. However, we expect that pretty soon, open source powered tablets will gain

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ground and take the leadership position, just like Android has managed to do in the smartphones category. The good news is that an Indian firm, Olive Telecom, has taken the initiative in this field. It has recently launched the OlivePad, which is powered by Android, in India. It's priced lower than the iPad but is it a better alternative? Turn to Page 102 to find out.

Best wishes,



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